

9.4 AV-out / HDMI

Almost all digital cameras these days, such as the Sony W35S, come with an AV-out port. AV-out is provided so that you can connect the camera to a TV or any other display system that supports AV and view your pictures or videos directly from the camera. Once the camera is connected, switch to the video mode on your TV. Next, switch the camera to play mode. This lets you view your pictures or videos on the TV screen instead of the camera's LCD. There are, however, some things to keep in mind like the region specification. TVs usually use the NTSC or PAL system. India uses PAL, so make sure it's set accordingly. To change the settings, navigate the menu to go to video-out and select PAL. An AV cable has two plugs at one end. One carries audio (usually white) and the other carries the video signal (usually yellow). These two plugs go into the TV's 'AV in' receptacle. The other end goes into the camera socket. The AV-out feature comes in handy if you want to show your pictures or videos to a few people. It can even be used to stream whatever the camera's picking up directly to a large screen – very useful when dealing with a much larger audience such as a concert or gathering. You may or may not record the video, but can still stream it.



HDMI again is like the big brother to AV-out. Since TVs are surely moving towards High Definition (HD), cameras cannot be left far behind. HDMI first started appearing on still cameras around the beginning of 2006. These days, even decently high-end cameras, such as the Nikon Coolpix S60, come with an HDMI port. HDMI lets you transmit really high resolution video output to an HDTV or screen directly from the camera. HDMI stands for high-definition multimedia interface and transmits uncompressed digital data. It supports up to eight channels of audio and high clarity visual data with only a single cable. While AV falls short in really large screens, HDMI handles them beautifully. The real difference in quality between the two will be apparent only when transmitting to large (say 42-inch plus) HD screens.